

COLLABORATIVE DISCUSSION 2: SUMMARY POST

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The highlight was discovering that the posts broadly coincide in seeing rapid progress in LLM capabilities and deployments bringing alongside tensions: rights, transparency and ethics.

My initial post focused on LLMs' evolution and their productivity gains (Noy and Zhang, 2023), for example through models such as GPT-5.5, while also providing the illusion of “simulated cognition” (Hutson, 2021; Shojaei et al., 2025). This gap, coupled with the rapid adoption of LLMs through agentic tools and chatbots, surfaced concerns and made me question whether mainstream use can produce a form of cognitive outsourcing that may affect human critical thinking in the long term (Sparrow, Liu and Wegner, 2011).

Peer feedback enriched this perspective by grounding these risks in structural and field-specific context. Peer 1 reinforced the threat of cognitive dependency, linking it to the “Google effect” (Sparrow, Liu and Wegner, 2011): why would we remember information if we can rely on Google to retrieve it for us? Conversely, Peer 2 challenged the causal link of my analogy to social media, proposing a deployment framework instead.

Furthermore, the forum exchange surfaced a paradox in the writing and creative domains: while LLMs can augment individual abilities, they simultaneously reduce diversity by producing more similar outputs (Doshi and Hauser, 2024).

Forum posts broadly identified the advantages of LLMs through references and use cases within the writing and related fields, while at the same time areas such as ethics (Floridi et al., 2018), copyright (United States Copyright Office, 2025), risks and transparency (Resnik and Hosseini, 2025) surfaced as points to be addressed. Reflecting on the Industry 5.0 readings, I can see the parallelism with the shift from a techno-economic to a socio-technical future, and how the forum discussion suggests that LLMs are not simply productivity tools, but socio-technical systems whose individual benefits may generate collective risks (Morales, Nousala and Ghobakhloo, 2024; Nousala, Metcalf and Ing, 2024).

To conclude, from the content I have reflected in these short discussions and the readings, there is evidence to support that LLMs deliver benefits in many areas related to writing and creativity; however, their technical progress and adoption are advancing faster than governance can adapt to and address the risks associated with it. Therefore, the question I propose the focus should be on is, how to moderate and govern ethically and addressing the risks whilst supporting the fast pace the AI industry imposes, and in parallel understand and measure the equation of benefits and rewards versus cost, including intangible ones.

References

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